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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR /IMPROVEMENT/ REAPPEARANCE
EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025
FIRST SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG1DSCENG100 –
**LITERARY GENRES: POETRY, FICTION AND FOLK TALES**

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

**Scheme of Valuation**

**Part A**
**Multiple Choice Questions**
**Answer All Questions. Each Question carries 1 mark**.

1. a. Humans (CO1, CO2, CO6)
2. b. Apples (CO1,CO2)
3. a. Silky Bob (CO2, CO4, CO5, CO6)
4. b. The sacrificial egg (CO2, CO4, CO5, CO6)
5. c. Western goods in the market (CO2, CO4, CO5, CO6)
6. c. Materialism (CO2, CO4, CO5, CO6)
7. c. three pots of gold (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)
8. a. a tree with woody gourds (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)
9. b. Son of Adam (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)
10. c. The significance of oral traditions and storytelling (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)

[10x1 = 10]

**PART B**
**Objective Type Questions**
**Answer any 10 Questions. Each Question carries 1 mark.**

11. Tagore wants to free the human mind from fear, narrow domestic walls, dead habits, prejudices, superstitions etc. (CO1, CO2)
12. The gathering swallows twitter in the skies. (CO1, CO2)
13. Monsieur Loisel helps his wife by working extra jobs and borrowing money to replace the lost necklace. (CO2, CO4, CO5, CO6)
14. The statue of the Happy Prince and the dead Swallow are recognized by God, who orders the angels to bring their souls to heaven. (CO2, CO4, CO5, CO6)
15. Madame Loisel loses the necklace at the Minister's ball, probably on the streets or the cab while making their way back home. (CO2, CO4, CO5, CO6)
16. The husband notices the coat and shoes, questions the wife, does not receive a satisfactory answer, becomes suspicious, leading to an unpleasant quarrel and leaving the house to sleep at the monkey-god's temple. (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)
17. The three cousins decide who marries the aunt's daughter by competing for her hand. The aunt's husband, faced with three eligible suitors, gives them 100 rupees each and challenges them to buy the best thing they can with it. The suitor who returns with the

best item will marry their daughter as this will determine who is the smartest among them. (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)

18. Mvoo Laana was deceived by the man whom he released from the hunting trap on the fourth day. (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)
19. The giant says that the second pot of gold is for the friars who come to carry away Little John's body, believing he perished at night in the palace. (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)
20. Little John confronts the giant in the palace. (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)
21. Mvoo Laana eats all the cakes on the way. (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)
22. The giant opens the cellar door in Dauntless Little John. (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)

[10x1 =10]

## PART C
### Short Answer Questions (50 Words)
### Answer any 5 Questions. Each Question carries 2 marks.

23. Emblem books are early illustrated books combining images with short moral or poetic texts. They use symbolic pictures (emblems), mottos, and explanatory verses to teach moral, religious, or philosophical lessons. Popular in the Renaissance, they helped readers interpret symbolic meaning in literature. (CO1, CO2, CO6)
24. The speaker says the parents of her English were ‘working in someone’s kitchen, cooking a meal it would never eat and toiling in someone’s land, growing flowers it would never smell.’ (CO1, CO2, CO6)
25. "A laggard in love and a dastard in war" describes the man Ellen had consented to marry. The bridegroom lacked the bravery and passion that Lochinvar possessed. (CO1, CO2)
26. Setting gives a novel its atmosphere, social background, and context. It shapes characters’ behaviour, influences plot events, and anchors themes. Time, place, and cultural environment help readers understand motivations and conflicts. (CO2, CO4, CO5, CO6)
27. The irony lies in Madame Loisel’s years of suffering to replace a necklace that was actually fake. She loses her beauty and youth repaying a debt for something worthless: a twist that exposes the tragedy of vanity/materialism. (CO2, CO4, CO5, CO6)
28. The smallpox outbreak disrupts daily life, shuts down the market and creates fear. (CO2, CO4, CO5, CO6)
29. In "A Story and a Song," the housewife's story and song are ultimately lost, as she had forgotten all about the story and the song by the time her husband returns home. (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)
30. Grimms’ tales have a ubiquitous cultural presence due to their widespread adaptations in both “high culture and popular culture”- in cinematic imagination, work of photographers, musicians and writers. (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)

[5x2=10]

## PART D
### Short Essay Questions (150 Words)
### Answer any 5 Questions. Each Question carries 5 marks.

31. John Lennon’s "Imagine" conveys unity through imagining a world without divisions (based on heaven and hell, countries, religion, no possessions) and living life in peace.

(CO1, CO2, CO6)

32. In "Sonnet 29," the speaker finds wealth and contentment through thoughts of his beloved, stating, "For thy sweet love remembered such wealth brings." (CO1, CO2)
33. In "Annabelle Lee," sepulchre refers to the tomb by the sea, symbolizing love persisting beyond death ("In her sepulchre there by the sea..."). (CO1, CO2)
34. Jimmy faces a moral dilemma between loyalty to his old friend Bob and his duty as a police officer. Recognising Bob as a wanted criminal forces him to choose justice over friendship. He avoids arresting Bob himself, showing emotional conflict but moral firmness. (CO2, CO3, CO5, CO6)
35. Madame Loisel envies Madame Forestier's wealth. Their relationship is polite but strained by class differences. Forestier's casual generosity contrasts with Loisel's insecurity; the revelation of the fake necklace shows Forestier was truthful and innocent, while Loisel's pretensions caused her downfall. (CO2, CO3, CO5, CO6)
36. Stream of consciousness is a literary technique presenting a character's continuous flow of thoughts and feelings. It is non-linear, associative, and often fragmented, giving readers direct access to interior consciousness. (CO2, CO3, CO5, CO6)
37. The story uses traditional fairy-tale elements like magical objects (the mirror, chariot, and stick) and a wise old man who guides the girl and her mother, but its structure differs from typical linear tales. Instead of a single heroic quest, it centres on riddles, tests, and the rivalry among three cousins, making human reasoning—not magic—the key to resolution. This gives the tale a more culturally grounded, communal, and intellectually driven form than standard fairy tales. (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)
38. The three cousins' relationship reflects rivalry, cooperation, and moral testing. Their interactions show conflict through competitions, resolution through intellect and fairness, and moral lessons about humility and cleverness. Their dynamic structure gives the tale depth beyond a simple fairy-tale conflict. (CO2, CO3, CO4, CO5)

[5x5=25]

## PART E
## Essay Questions (300 WORDS)
## Answer any 1 Question. Each Question carries 15 marks.

39. In "Mimesis," the father tells his daughter to tear down the spider's web on her bicycle so she can ride it again. The daughter refuses and responds by saying that forcing the spider out of its home would be like making others become refugees. The poem shows empathy and understanding of displacement. (CO1, CO2, CO6)
40. The story shows cultural identity through Julius's conflict between his Western education and the traditional Igbo beliefs he witnesses in the market, the rituals, and the sacrificial egg he accidentally steps on. Although he knows such beliefs have no place in rational thinking, the later deaths of Ma and Janet—and the empty market he looks out on—force him to confront the community's traditional explanations and the power those beliefs hold. The story remains relevant because it depicts how individuals still navigate the tension between modern ideas and deeply rooted cultural practices. (CO2, CO4, CO5, CO6)

[1x15=15]